

THE ARMY MILITARY-CIVILIAN COST SYSTEM (AMCOS) FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS



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ACRONYM

AMCOS ACRONYM GUIDE

AMCOS	Army Military Civilian Cost System
AOC	Area of Concentration
APPN	Appropriation
ASA (FM&C)	Assistant Secretary of the Army (Financial Management & Comptroller)
ATRRS	Army Training Requirements & Resources System
BAH	Basic Allowance for Housing
BLS	Bureau of Labor Statistics
CAC	Common Access Card
CAPE	Cost Assessment and Program Evaluation
CBA	Cost Benefit Analysis
CCE	Contractor Cost Estimate
CES	Cost Estimating Structure
CMF	Career Management Field
CMP	Contractor Management Plan
COLA	Cost of Living Allowance
CP	Career Program
DASA-CE	Deputy Assistant Secretary of the Army for Cost and Economics
DCPS	Defense Civilian Personnel System
DISA	Defense Information Systems Agency
DMDC	Defense Manpower Data Center
DoDI	Department of Defense Instruction
DTMO	Defense Travel Management Office
EAMS	Enterprise Architecture Management System
ECEC	Employer Costs for Employee Compensation
ECOD	Estimated Cost of Damage
FCOM	Full Cost of Manpower
FICA	Federal Insurance Contributions Act
FTE	Full-Time Equivalent
GAO	Government Accountability Office
GCDS	Global Content Delivery Service
GFEBs	General Fund Enterprise Business System
ICAM	Individual Cost Assessment Model
J-Books	Congressional Justification Books
JIC	Joint Inflation Calculator
JTR	Joint Travel Regulation
LCAT	Labor Categories
METEOR	Manpower Cost Estimating Tool for Enhanced Online Reporting
MILTECH	Military Technician
MOS	Military Occupation Specialties
NDAA	National Defense Authorization Act

NIPRNET	Non-Classified Internet Protocol Router Network
O*NET	Occupational Information Network
OCONUS	Outside the Continental US
OHA	Overseas Housing Allowance
OM	Operations and Maintenance
OPM	Office of Personnel Management
OSD	Office of the Secretary of Defense
OT	Overtime pay
PAM	Personnel Authorizations Module
PB	President Budget
PCS	Permanent Change of Station
RDT&E	Research, Development, Test & Evaluation
RSE	Relative Standard Error
SAG	System Architecture Group
SAW	Strategic Army Workforce
SOC	Standard Occupation Classification
STIG	Security and Development Security Technical Implementation Guides
STRL	Science and Technology Reinvention Laboratory
TDA	Table of Distribution and Allowances
TDY	Temporary Duty Travel
TRADOC	Army Training and Doctrine Command
UIC	Unit Identification Code
WOMOS	Warrant Officer Military Occupational Specialty
YoE	Years of Experience
YOS	Years of Service

AMCOS APPROPRIATIONS

MPA	Military Personnel Army
MPA Non-Pay	Military Personnel Army Non-Pay
NGPA	Military Personnel Army National Guard
RPA	Military Personnel Army Reserve
OMA	Operations and Maintenance Army
OMNGA	Operations and Maintenance National Guard
OMAR	Operations and Maintenance Reserve
OMDW	Operations and Maintenance Defense-wide
Federal OM	Operations and Maintenance Federal
OMA_1	Cost derived from the TRADOC-159 report which does not identify or segment by APPN. So, assumed to be OMA-funded.

AMCOS PAY PLANS

ACQUISITION DEMO

NH	Civilian Acquisition NH - Business & Tech Managment Professional
NJ	Civilian Acquisition NJ - Technical Management Support
NK	Civilian Acquisition NK - Administration Support

CIVILIAN (ALL OTHER)

AD	Administratively Determined
CA	Board of Contract Appeals
CCE	Contractor Cost Estimate
EE	Expert
EF	Consultant
EX	Executive
GG	Civilian Intelligence Personnel
GL	Civilian Law Enforcement Officer
GP	Civilian Physician and Dentist
GS	Civilian General Schedule
IE	Senior Intelligence Executive Services
IG	Inspectors General
IP	Senior Intelligence Professional
SES	Civilian Senior Executive Schedule
SL	Senior Level Positions
ST	Scientific and Professional
ZZ	Non-applicable

LABORATORY DEMO

DB	Civilian Acquisition DB - Demo Engr & Scientists
DE	Civilian Acquisition DE - Demo Engr & Scientists Tech
DJ	Civilian Acquisition DJ - Demo Administrative
DK	Civilian Acquisition DK - Demo General Support

MILITARY

AE	Active Enlisted
AO	Active Officer
AWO	Active Warrant Officer
NE	National Guard Enlisted
NO	National Guard Officer
NWO	National Guard Warrant Officer
RE	Reserve Enlisted
RO	Reserve Officer
RWO	Reserve Warrant Officer

WAGE (APPROPRIATED FUNDS)

WA	Lock & Dam Supervisor
WB	Wage not otherwise designated
WD	Production Facility Grade
WG	Civilian Wage Grade
WH	Hopper Dredge - nonsupervisory
WJ	Hopper Dredge Supervisor
WK	Hopper Dredge - nonsupervisory
WL	Civilian Wage Leader
WN	Production Facility Supervisor
WO	Lock & Dam Leader
WQ	Special Puerto Rico Grade Supervisory
WR	Special Puerto Rico Grade– Leader
WS	Civilian Wage Supervisor
WT	Trainees
WU	Special Puerto Rico Grade– nonsupervisory
WY	Lock & Dam Grade
XF	Floating Plant Grade
XG	Floating Plant Leader
XG	Floating Plant Leader
XH	Floating Plant Supervisor
XR	Flood Control - nonsupervisor
XT	Flood Control Leader
XU	Flood Control Supervisor

WAGE (NON-APPROPRIATED FUNDS)

CY	Civilian and Youth Programs
NA	Wage Grade
NL	Wage Leader
NS	Wage Supervisor
NF	Wage Pay Band

ACCOUNT

DOES MY AMCOS ACCOUNT EXPIRE?

In the cloud users will be required to log in every thirty days.

WHY IS AMCOS NOT ACCESSIBLE FROM THE COMMERCIAL INTERNET?

In order to be more secure in an era of increasing cyber threats, DoD and the Army are restricting access to DoD systems. This means that only systems with a valid need to be available from the commercial internet are made available (e.g. a recruiting site or a public affairs site). As AMCOS transitions to the cloud we will lose our white listing and thus each user will need access to a NIPRNet connection to reach the site. Users should contact their supervisory chain and/or their NEC to obtain NIPRNET access through the proper means.

APPROPRIATIONS

FOR ESTIMATING ARNG COSTS SHOULD I USE ALL THE APPROPRIATIONS OR JUST THE NG ONES?

AMCOS displays the appropriation associated with the source of funding for the activity. ARNG pay, recruiting, special pay, etc. are found in the NGPA budget and thus are labeled NGPA. Some elements though are paid for the 'Active Army' through MPA and OMA. For example, Active Army funded training courses (MPA/OMA) may be attended by ARNG soldiers thus the MPA/OMA designation. For ARNG officers the same is true but add to that the officer acquisition activities such as ROTC and UMSA, which are Active Army funded and they too carry MPA/OMA designations. For budgeting purposes use only the APPNs under the purview of the activity you are budgeting for. For costing purposes use all APPNs.

WHY ARE TRAINING APPROPRIATIONS SPLIT IN NATIONAL GUARD AND RESERVE TRAINING?

Prior versions of AMCOS used a single approach for training and thus displayed only the Active APPNs. The 2019 update to the training methodology introduced costs from the NG/R appropriations which are training specific. For example, there are Army run training courses which NG/R soldiers attend and the course is thus paid for out of MPA/OMA. But, there are also training costs which come from the NG/R appropriations, which are now displayed.

BUREAU OF LABOR STATISTICS OCCUPATIONAL EMPLOYMENT STATISTICS

HOW CAN I USE EXPERIENCE DESIGNATIONS FOR CCE?

AMCOS uses the Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS) data for the Contractor Cost Estimate (CCE) pay plan and as such we are beholden to the Standard Occupation Classification (SOC) system

(<https://www.bls.gov/soc/>). This system groups pay information by the Labor Categories (LCATs) contained within the SOC which may lack specific LCATs and/or experience designations. The best recommendation we can give is to find an LCAT in the SOC which as closely as possible resembles the LCAT you are looking for.

Regarding experience levels, the SOC system does not provide data by experience levels (e.g.e.g. junior/mid/senior). Instead the BLS data provides percentiles that can be used to create those tiers. For example mid might be the 50th percentile while senior is the 75th and junior is the 25th. While that is an example its best to compare your LCAT description, education, and experience qualifications against the definition of the SOC to determine which percentile matches up best with prefix/suffix. Keep in mind the SOCs don't use Education/Experience so by no means is it a perfect science.

SHOULD I USE THE MEDIAN OR THE MEAN?

When a company is looking at hiring candidates and setting pay they *typically* are looking at the median, not the mean. ERI, a leading salary survey provider puts it this way: "Medians are the preferred measure of central tendency in populations with skewed distributions or populations with large numbers of outliers" (Source: <https://www.eri.com/salariesurveys/faqs>). Pay scale also has a similar perspective: https://www.payscale.com/career-news/2006/09/if_median_is_be, and BLS: "Sometimes, a mean, or average doesn't convey much information, particularly if there is a wide distribution of values. For example, wages for a particular occupation may vary quite a bit. Learning about the distribution of wages can give more information about what an entry-level wage may look like compared with a wage with more experience" (<https://www.bls.gov/opub/hom/topic/distribution-statistics.htm>). The ability for the median to not be influenced by outliers is the key.

WHAT ARE THE CCE HEADERS IN AMCOS?

The fields for the Contract Cost Estimate headers (A_PCT10, A_PCT25, A_PC75 and A_PCT90) correspond to the percentiles reported by BLS. For example, A_PCT10 provides the annual salary amount for the 10th percentile. This means that 90% of the reported salaries corresponding to the filters selected make more than the stated amount. Thus, 25th percentile would mean 75% of the reported salaries make more than that amount. Many companies have a policy that they hire at the 50th percentile but may adjust higher or lower depending on things such as strategic importance, supply/demand affecting market conditions, etc. Also, the BLS data does not have years of experience associated with its Standard Occupational Categories (SOCs) therefore it may be prudent to select a higher or lower percentile to adjust for a more junior or senior position.

ARE THE MPA RECRUITING COSTS AND MPA NON-PAY PCS THE AVERAGE TOTAL COST SPREAD OUT OVER TIME?

The MPA Permanent Change of Station (PCS) documentation can be found in the AMCOS Cost Model Documentation under help documents on the website. MPA PCS costs in AMCOS are a function of the budget amount and the number of soldiers in inventory. On an individual soldier level the cost is a function of weight allowance per rank and dependants But AMCOS provides for an overall average.

DO MILITARY RATES INCLUDE DANGER PAY AND DBA COSTS?

For the Overseas Housing Allowance (OHA) to cost deployed Soldiers (no civilians or contractors), they would only get the Overseas Housing Allowance if they are deploying from an Overseas Location or if they have dependents in an overseas location. Overseas Housing Allowance is for rent or mortgages. If the Soldiers are deployed in tents or a barracks overseas in Iraq or Afghanistan they would not receive Iraq or Afghanistan OHA, but they would be getting OHA for rent or mortgages from Korea or Germany or some place similar if that is where they are deploying from or if they have dependents living in Germany or Korea or some place similar. Defense Base Act (DBA) insurance only applies to contractors and thus military rates do not include this.

DOES THE NAVY AND AIRFORCE HAVE A SIMILAR WEB SITE AVAILABLE?

If you're trying to find a similar costing system to AMCOS for a Joint Environment try the Full Cost of Manpower website (<https://fcom.cape.osd.mil/>) is the best place to start. This site provides basic information for each service. Each service may have their own product, which does similar manpower costing at a level deeper than that provided by FCoM. The Air Force's equivalent product might be Individual Cost Assessment Model (ICAM) while the Navy equivalent might be Manpower Cost Estimating Tool for Enhanced Online Reporting (METEOR).

HOW CAN I CREATE A COST SUMMARY FOR AN AWO, THAT INCLUDES LOCATION AND DEPENDENT STATUS?

The Location and Dependent Status drop down lists are hidden if you choose the "All" value or a Branch. But, they become visible if you choose a specific WOMOS. Also, most all of the dropdown lists now have a search feature. If you start typing after you click into the dropdown you're selecting from, the values will start to filter as you type the characters. It will narrow down the choices the further you type.

HOW DOES AMCOS DETERMINE WEAPON SPECIFIC TRAINING COSTS?

The Weapon System Manpower Summary (for Active, ARNG, & Reserve Pay Plans) is a modified Default summary. It includes additional columns for Army Cost Element Structure (CES), OSD Cost Assessment and Program Evaluation (CAPE) CES Title, and Weapon System Name.

The Weapon Specific Training was previously included within other training cost elements which were then rolled up and included in the total cost of training. Costs included in the Weapon Specific Training are those where the title and/or course number of a TRADOC course can be directly attributed to a specific weapon system. AMCOS uses TRADOC training data to generate the costs of training. Weapon Specific training costs were added to comply with the OSD CAPE Cost Element Structure requiring AMCOS provide more detail in training costs and adjust some of the long standing AMCOS processes.

IS THERE A STANDARD AVERAGE % TO USE IN THE OVERHEAD TO APPLY TO CONTRACTOR RATES?

There is not a 'standard' average to use. The overhead percentage, or wrap rate as it is sometimes referred to in totality, varies depending on industry, work type, and company to name a few factors. The best estimate would come from an existing contract where that data was required from the contractor. That said, it is possible to provide some data on possible ranges. Grant Thornton typically releases a contractor survey each year with the latest being available from 2017. The below table provides a summary of the data it provides (<https://www.grantthornton.com/-/media/content-page-files/public-sector/pdfs/surveys/2018/2017-government-contractor-survey.ashx>)

	Wrap Rate	Fringe Benefits	Overhead Rate	G&A	MH
Company Site					
Min	1.47			5%	2%
Avg/Median	2.1 (avg)	36% (median)	50% (median)	13% (TCI) / 15% VAC	3.8% (median)
Max	3			30%	9%
Client Site					
Min	1.4			5%	2%
Avg	1.9 (avg)	36% (median)	33% (median)	13% (TCI) / 15% VAC	3.8% (median)
Max	2.3			30%	9%

Overhead is a contributing factor in the survey to the total cost (wrap rate). Fringe is going to be the equivalent of what AMCOS calls the Cost of Benefits. AMCOS obtains our Avg Cost of Benefits from the Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS), which is 30% as of 2020. Compare the BLS ACoB (30%) to the GT survey of 36%. Using some math one could back into what a reasonable overhead number is to use:

Company site: $(1\$ (\text{salary}) * X) + 1.3 (\text{Fringe}) = 2.1$; $X =$ an Overhead of 80%

Client site: $(1\$ (\text{salary}) * X) + 1.3 (\text{Fringe}) = 1.9$; $X =$ an Overhead of 60%

Both of the above use the average wrap rate but it could be repeated with the min/max.

IS THERE A WAY FOR THE MODEL TO INCLUDE SUB-COST ELEMENT DATA?

Sub-cost element data is provided by the website via the detailed summary up to a certain point. If you are looking to understand more about each of these feeder elements the Cost Element Data Dictionary, under the Help Docs link, provides a detailed basis of computation.

SHOULD I SELECT NON-SPECIFIC LOCATIONS AND/OR DEPENDENTS?

The answer is it depends on your circumstances. If you know enough about the position/population you are costing and are confident in the location and dependant status then make the appropriate selections. If you are unsure of the location you may select 'All' or if you know the location but are unsure of the dependant status you may select 'Average.'

USING “THEN-DOLLAR-TO-THEN-DOLLAR” OR “THEN-YEAR-TO-CONSTANT-DOLLAR”?

The type of dollars you use depends on what you are working on. Budget work tends to use “Then-To-Then” year dollars mostly while cost analysts tend to use “Then-to-Constant” dollars or show their estimates in both constant and then year dollars. You should ask the leader of the project you are working on or the leader who will be receiving the product how they want to see the dollars. Your supervisor or team leader may know as well if it’s an analysis that is done all the time.

Please Note: The Army has not yet transitioned to OSD CAPE’s new inflation/escalation policies that contain Constant Price Dollars.

WHAT ARE THE DIFFERENT SUMMARIES AND WHAT COST FACTORS ARE IN EACH SUMMARY?

There are five cost summary formats (Default, Training, Weapon System Manpower, Detailed, and Ancillary) are provided. The AMCOS Default Summary is used for CBA cost estimation. The Training Summary only retrieves and sums the Default Summaries’ Training costs for users focused on training only. For weapon system costing, the Weapon System Manpower Summary is a modified Default Summary providing additional detail for training and breakouts by weapon system. The Detailed Summary totals the same as the Default Summary but shows the child cost elements that make up the parent cost elements seen in the Default Summary. The Ancillary Cost Summary shows the actual costs of some elements. Users with special cost allocation needs may take the actual cost and apply a different methodology as needed.

WHAT COSTS ARE INCLUDED IN TRAINING DOLLARS ?

The training costs displayed in AMCOS are based on the ATRM-159 report we receive annually from TRADOC. It breaks out MPA, OMA, and OMA Other costs on a per attendee basis for each course. The maintenance of training systems, which are under school house control and is used as part of the course should be included in the ATRM-159 report and thus AMCOS. Please keep in mind that AMCOS does further processing to the TRADOC 159 report data to compute average costs which are then distributed across later grade levels in a process we call Cross Grade Level Averaging. See the Cost Model documentation for further information on how this works.

WHAT OTHER DATA IS IN AMCOS BESIDES COST INFORMATION?

AMCOS includes Pay Tables, Inventory, and Civilian General Schedule (GS) Locality Rates by Zip Code lookup. These items are located under the “Data” menu tab.

Under the “Help & Support” Menu tab, a link to the AMCOS Data Element Dictionary and other documents are provided to include the DASA-CE CBA Guide, tutorials (AMCOS LITE, Project Manager, and Xwalk), methodology documents (Salary, Civilian Health Insurance, Inflation/Discounting, Xwalk, and Contractor Cost Estimating), Fact Sheet, FAQ, and an AMCOS Release/Update History which provides previous releases’ change/update information.

WHEN DID CIVILIAN COSTS CHANGE TO “THEN YEAR/CURRENT YEAR FROM “BASE YEAR/CONSTANT \$”

AMCOS has Civilian Cost expressed in "Then Year/Current Year. Some cost analysts may recall that in the past, civilian costs were "Base Year/Constant \$. The change to have Civilian Cost as "Then Year/Current Year" was implemented 21 March 2013, as part of the Redesigned Project Manager (PM) release. In the past some cost analysts had civilian cost as "Base Year/Constant \$". The PM implemented the Joint Inflation Calculator, OMB discount rates, and revised methodology. While doing so, the accuracy of Home Page "Base Year/Constant \$" comment was questioned, reviewed by DASA-CE, and the comment corrected to state Civilian Costs are expressed in "Then Year/Current Year". The following rationale is provided:

- The present Military Default Summary costs are expressed in current dollars as we have MPA and OMA dollars in that summary. We do not convert our OMA costs to constant dollars. Thus, our summary is in current dollars.
- The Civilian Default Summary uses OMA for government costs and Civilian Pay for the rest of the factors; so, they are also in current dollars due to the OMA. We do not convert the gov't costs into constant dollars.
- The DODI CAPE MIL and Civilian rates use a lot of OMA; thus, they are in current dollars, as we do not convert the OMA costs into constant dollars. The non-OMA costs do not require a conversion.

Please Note: The Army has not yet transitioned to OSD CAPE's new inflation/escalation policies that contain Constant Price Dollars.

WHERE IS THE COST FACTOR CALCULATION LOCATED?

The "Cost Element Data Dictionary" page under the Help & Support menu tab contains information on each cost factor including a description, business logic, the basis of computation, and data source.

WHICH COST SUMMARY SHOULD I USE?

The default, Weapon System Summary, and detailed summaries all provide the same total cost with varying levels of detail. The training summary only focuses on training costs while the ancillary summary provides actual costs which may be used in specific circumstances where AMCOS' Cross Grade Level Averaging (CGLA) is not desired.

DATA EXPORTS

CAN I GET THE FULL DATA SET THAT SITS BEHIND AMCOS FOR CONTRACTOR RELATED COSTS?

AMCOS pulls the CCE data directly from the Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS) OES program. Details of the program and numerous export options are available at <https://www.bls.gov/oes/#data>. If you have any questions about how we use the data or ways to export/obtain the information you are looking for do not hesitate to let me know.

HOW DO I GET THE DATA TABLES INTO A FORM THAT CAN BE USED FOR ANALYSIS?

AMCOS provides the ability to export these tables directly into MS Excel. When you have the information that you want showing on your screen, simply click the Excel icon and a prompt will show you how to save your file. The alternate method is simply to cut and paste the table you wish to use from AMCOS into your preferred application.

WHERE IS THE ARMY COST ESTIMATING STRUCTURE XWALK?

The Army Cost Estimating Structure (CES) updates are included in the current release of AMCOS. AMCOS remapping largely matches the existing OSD CAPE mapping, just with the Army CES numbers. You can download the crosswalk from Help Docs/Data Exports/Army Current-Former CES Xwalk.

INVENTORY

DOES AMCOS CALCULATE A WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST FOR EACH RANK FOR YOS?

AMCOS Lite calculates a weighted average cost for each rank that accounts for distribution of Years of Service (YoS) (per the inventory tables). AMCOS does not provide a weighted average cost for each YoS. The underlying methodology wasn't designed to support that and unfortunately there is not an easy way for us to provide such a number since many of the calculations use YoS within each rank as well as the inventory associated with years of service.

DOES AMCOS INVENTORY INCLUDE TEMPORARY HIRES?

It depends. The GFEBS based pay plans (AD, GP, Acq Demo and Lab Demo) do not include seasonal or temporary hires. This is done to eliminate the potential skewing those individuals may have on annualized cost estimates. DMDC based pay plans (e.g. GS) may include temporary hires but they do not skew the computations since AMCOS uses the OPM pay schedules, essentially treating them as if they are full time.

IS THE GS PAY TABLE AN AVERAGE OF ALL CIVILIANS OR FOR A SPECIFIC PLACE?

The costs in AMCOS represent the weighted average pay based on the grade level and step of civilians in the specific location. When costs are shown but no inventory is present then the average step for that pay plan and grade level is assumed. The weighted pay is also influenced by the OPM Pay Schedule of the selected location which is set and adjusted each year.

WHAT DOES THE STEP 99 REPRESENT ON THE INVENTORY TABLE?

In AMCOS, 99 for YOS and Step represents an unknown value. AMCOS obtains inventory data from DMDC which in turn obtains their data from the services. In some cases the data that is aggregated up to DMDC and passed along to AMCOS has unknowns in it for a myriad of potential reasons. In the inventory module we display those unknown values for completeness, but as the AMCOS Cost Model Documentation explains, such unknown values are excluded from the cost calculations.

WHY DOES AMCOS NOT HAVE THE MOS OR AOC SPECIALTY I'M LOOKING FOR?

When a military specialty is not shown in an AMCOS drop down, there is no inventory due to a Military Occupation Specialties (MOS) or Area of Concentration (AOC) conversion to a new specialty. You may also want to check the National Guard / Reserves component pay plans for the MOS or AOC. If you know the new MOS or AOC, then check to see if it is in the drop down list. You can also verify whether there is reported inventory by selecting Inventory found under the DATA Tab. Lastly, you should check whether the MOS or AOC was converted, deleted, or added by going to HQ Army G1s Personnel Authorizations Module (PAM) using the following web link: <https://pamweb.armyg1.army.pentagon.mil/default.aspx>.

WHY IS THERE NO INFORMATION FOR CERTAIN GRADE LEVELS IN CERTAIN SUB-GROUPS?

AMCOS data is largely inventory driven. AMCOS calculations are based on the most recently completed Fiscal Year (FY) Army inventory with an as of date of 30 Sep. This means cost data will only be displayed for Groups (Career Management Field (CMFs), Occupational Groups, etc.), Sub-Groups (Military Occupation Specialties (MOS), Series, etc.) and Grades where Army inventory data has personnel counts of one or more. If the inventory data we receive does not show data in a particular grade, that grade will not appear in any of the cost grids. The one exception to this is Civilian Intelligence Personnel (GG), Law Enforcement Officer (GL) and General Schedule (GS), pay plans which as of the Spring 2020 release have costs for all valid and applicable grade level and location combinations at the group level. AMCOS defines valid grade levels based on OPM guidance for which grade levels are applicable for which specialty types. AMCOS defines applicable as a particular subgroup which exists anywhere in inventory. Subgroups which do not have any inventory for a pay plan do not generate costs.

JOINT INFLATION CALCULATOR (JIC)

HOW DOES AMCOS DETERMINE APPROPRIATIONS AND INFLATION?

The appropriations used in AMCOS are in direct relation to the budget books. Thus, MPA in AMCOS is Military Personnel Army. When translated to how the JIC refers to them though the nomenclature changes slightly as we use Army-Military Pay (MPA) Appropriation (Escalation). For the NG it would look like this: NGPA as the appropriation from the budget book tied to the JIC inflation type of Army-Military Pay Army National guard (MPA-ARNG) Appropriation Composite. There is not an official "Military Pay Army" so it should be "Military Personnel Army". MPA covers clothing, subsistence, housing allowance, and other non-pay personnel costs.

AMCOS' use of inflation is governed by the following:

- AMCOS MPA = JIC MPA (Escalation)
- AMCOS Non-Pay = JIC MPA Non-Pay
- JIC MPA Composite - not used by AMCOS

AMCOS only uses MPA Non-Pay at this time for PCS. The JIC guidance on the use of the composite rate is as follows: "...it is up to the analyst and their organization to decide on when composite indexes are appropriate. If you have knowledge of the personnel vs. purchases distribution in your estimates

you will have a better estimate making use of that information and estimate each separately. Remember the composites reflect a service wide weighting of purchases and manpower and if you are dealing with estimates that don't reflect that distribution (a likely case) you are just adding noise to the numbers." If you know, for the purpose of your cost estimate, that additional elements beyond what AMCOS considers non-pay should be included in non-pay inflation then we suggest you manually inflate those using the non-pay factor. We do not recommend you use the composite rate since we are unsure at this time whether AMCOS' MPA elements are, or are not, representative of all the costs reflected in the composite inflation rate (for example the composite rate could include indirect costs not accounted for in AMCOS' manpower estimates).

Please Note: The Army has not yet transitioned to OSD CAPE's new inflation/escalation policies that contain Constant Price Dollars.

WHY IS OMA THE ONLY APPROPRIATION APPLICABLE TO CCE?

OMA was used because it is the largest appropriation with contractor labor. Let's say you needed to estimate the cost of a contracted Operations Research Analyst (ORSA). If you look up Operations Research and select one at the 75th percentile you would get a cost like \$178,325 in AMCOS under OMA. If for your estimate your contractor ORSA is paid out of RDTE dollars instead you would just start with the \$178,325 as RDTE. Then, you would apply the Joint Inflation Calculator to the \$178,325 as if it were RDTE dollars if you need to inflate/escalate it over the years of the POM.

METHODOLOGY

ARE RESERVE MANPOWER COSTS COMPLIANT WITH DODI 7041.04?

The answer is "not applicable." AMCOS is in compliance with DoDI 7041.04 based on the amended guidance we have from the FCoM team (they've made changes to the CEs since the last 2013 was released). But the memo states "Reserve and National Guard military manpower costs are not addressed in this instruction." AMCOS has followed the spirit of the DODI for reserve component manpower costing but since that DoDI doesn't tell us specifically how to cost reserve component manpower the answer is: not applicable, or yes, to the best of our understanding.

DOES AMCOS HAVE ARNG AGR AND MILTECH COMPOSITE P&A RATES?

No, AMCOS doesn't have AGR or MILTECH rates. For AGR our customers use the active military in AMCOS and modify. The AMCOS CBA Guide tells you what to modify and from your experience you might think of more to modify. The Civ Pay Rates have MILTECH rates. The Civ Pay Rates are by Command. The Civ Pay Rates are budget and wouldn't have training, supplies, DoD, or Federal costs, or travel costs.

DOES THE CIVILIAN TRAINING IN AMCOS INCLUDE TDY COSTS?

Yes, the AMCOS civilian training cost does include TDY, but the cost only covers ACTEDS, Acquisition and SAW training (old names). The link below calls the programs The Army Career Development Program, Acquisition Corps Education and The Army Civilian Training and Leadership Development

Program (newer names). Any other training would need to be added to the cost. AMCOS obtains its civilian training cost from FCoM. Page 506 of the Budget link below shows travel costs. Additionally, the definitions in cPROBE for ACTEDs and SAW include travel costs. References: FY21 pb sag 334, page 506 (PDF page 510) says. It includes a travel component. SAG 334 / inventory is how FCoM generates the training cost we use.

https://www.asafm.army.mil/Portals/72/Documents/BudgetMaterial/2021/Base%20Budget/Operation%20and%20Maintenance/OMA_VOL_1_FY_2021_PB_Army_Volume_1.pdf.

334751000 - Army Civ Trng, Education, and Dev System

Covers costs and, where prescribed, manpower authorizations required to support training, education, and development activities for DA civilian employees pursuant to applicable DA, DOD, and/or Federal Regulations, Policies, and Laws. Included are interns, Senior Executive Service members, managers, supervisors, and potential leaders. Programs include senior service schools and competitive professional development opportunities. Funding may include: tuition, books, fees, programmed instructional and self-study course materials, supplies, equipment, and related authorized expenses; travel and per diem of students/participants to and from the training site and while in attendance; intern travel and per diem during the intern formal OJT/classroom training period; travel and per diem of instructors to conduct such training when such travel is in the best interest of the Government; transportation and storage of household goods for participants in training, education or developmental assignments which are in excess of 120 calendar days and when such PCS would be appropriate; contract costs associated with development, testing, conducting, and/or evaluation of new and/or revised training courses at the Center for Army Leadership (Civilian Leadership Training Division), the Army Management Staff College, and/or the Civilian Leader Development Cell at HQ TRADOC; salary and benefit costs incurred for long-term training assignments (in excess of 120 calendar days) and approved or sponsored by HQDA (in accordance with guidance issued in the ACTEDS Training Catalog [<http://www.cpol.army.mil/train/catalog/>]); and salary and benefit costs of interns assigned to the ACTEDS TDA. Army National Guard (ARNG) and US Army Reserve (USAR) employees are excluded only from ACTEDS Leader Development Training (see paragraphs 334741.20, 334751.21, 334751.22, 334751.23, 334751.25). EXCLUDES all employees paid from Civil Function (Civil Works and Cemetery), all employees paid from Non-Appropriated Funds, and all military students.

334752000 - Army Acquisition Civilian Training Program

No definition

334755000 - Strategic Army Workforce (SAW)

The Strategic Army Workforce program includes manpower authorizations and costs, temporary duty travel (TDY), permanent change of station (PCS), rotation, training, professional development, and administrative costs of centrally managed high-grade civilian supervisors and managers. It also includes automation and support equipment, necessary facilities, and associated costs.

HOW DO I DETERMINE WHETHER CIVILIANS, CONTRACTORS, OR MILITARY ARE CHEAPER IN RELATION TO THE 10% HEADQUARTERS REDUCTION?

To determine whether civilians, contractors, or military are cheaper in relation to the 10% headquarters reduction, see the GAO Report on the study.

IF I WANTED TO CREATE HOURLY RATES, WOULD I USE A FULL YEAR AT 5 DAYS PER WEEK, 8 HOURS PER DAY (2,080 HOURS)?

For the hourly rate, use 2080 hours. The BLS OE series data (which AMCOS contractor costs are based on) uses 2080 and is thus the correct number. Note that in reality this number varies year to year but typically 2,080 is considered the correct number which includes work hours and leave hours.

OUR ORGANIZATION IS WORKING A CBA FOR AN EMPLOYEE WHO WANTS A VERA/VSIP, AND WANTS TO KNOW WHAT WE WOULD USE AS A BURDENED RATE.

For Cost Benefit Analysis (CBA) cost estimates, AMCOS has the base pay and all the burdens needed. For burdened rates (including benefits and retirement) should be more than 20%.

WHEN SHOULD THE FEDERAL FUNDED COSTS BE USED?

If you are comparing the cost of contractors to that of civilians and military, use Army, DoD and Federal costs since some of the retirement and other costs are paid by non Army sources. Excluding federal funded costs from the comparison would create an unbalanced comparison by omitting valid costs.. Refer to DoDI 7041.04 if you are comparing the costs of contractors with military and civilian employees.

WHAT'S INCLUDED IN TRAINING COSTS?

Visit the Help and Support tab in AMCOS and open the AMCOS Model Documentation and look for "Average Cost of Training". Please notice the many feeder cost elements such as Career Training, Professional Training, Weapon Specific Training, etc.

WHAT IS WEIGHTED AVERAGE PAY?

AMCOS previously did not get inventory data by location so weighted pay was calculated as such (both done by various levels of aggregation e.g. All/group/subgroup):

$$\text{sum (inventory by GL/step * base pay by GL/step) / sum (inventory by GL/step) * locality pay}$$

In the May 2020 release we started getting DMDC inventory by location so the calculation is now done:

$$\text{sum (inventory by GL/step/location * locality pay by GL/step) / sum (inventory by GL/step/location)}$$

Because of the above, pay may go up/down from the prior release depending on the weighting specific to the location selected. Also, because we are computing weighted average pay at the All and Group level instead of a straight average pay those aggregation levels may also change. Now every year the weighting of people at various steps within a grade level shifts so pay may go up or down depending on that in relation to the changes in locality pay, but because of the shift in methodology this year brought on by the additional location data you may see shifts that are larger than you've seen in the past. Because

of the additional level of granularity in this release, the average costs are more reflective of the conditions in each location rather than the more general calculations used in the past.

WHAT NUMBER SHOULD BE USED TO CALCULATE AN HOURLY RATE FOR ARMY MILITARY PERSONNEL?

If you are working with reimbursable rates for budgeting, the DoD factor may be best to use. The GFEBS standard reimbursable factor is 1776 hours, but users can change the hours for their unique situations. For TDA usage for TDA military and civilians Congressional mandated work hours per year are 2087 hours; 1740 hours 145 * 12 are the available hours. For FTEs the days and hours change per year.

WHY DID COST "TREASURY CONTRIBUTION TO RETIREMENT" RATES DECREASE?

Effective with the June 2018 out of cycle release, the cost element "Treasury Contribution to Retirement" was removed. OSD CAPE stopped using this cost element because it is a set contribution each year and is not paid per Servicemember. The 2004 National Defense Authorization Act (NDAA) added the U.S. Treasury payment for payments made to the Military Retirement Fund Object Class (OC) 13.0 to cover a portion of the accrued unfunded liability for all the retirees and current members who had earned benefits before the accrual funding system was set up. Since we were receiving the cost from FCOM and they stopped using it we removed it from AMCOS. There was no replacement for that cost so that caused the average cost of payplans that use it to drop.

This resulted in some minor changes in OMDW and Federal OM cost elements, but also resulted in the elimination of the cost element "Treasury Contribution to Retirement". The result of these changes is a net reduction in costs. The current values shown in AMCOS are correct and a full accounting of the changes included in the recent release and all previous releases can be found in the document linked on the AMCOS homepage titled "AMCOS Release/Update History".

MILITARY TRAINING

IS THERE A WAY TO GET A COST FOR ATTENDING PILOT TRAINING?

The best place to locate this information is the ATRM-159 report from TRADOC which you may obtain directly from them or from the AMCOS help desk. In that report you'd have to determine the which courses you consider general pilot training and then include those in your analysis.

WHAT'S THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN AMCOS VS FCOM?

The biggest difference in AMCOS and FCoM is how the models cost military training. AMCOS and FCoM estimate the same cost elements but use different methodology for costing them. Both follow Department of Defense Instruction (DoDI) 7041.04. written by OSD CAPE. DoDI 7041.04 establishes policy, assigns responsibilities, and provides procedures to estimate and compare the full costs of active duty military and DoD civilian manpower and contract support. OSD CAPE has a tool called FCoM, but it has no ability to cost the Reserve Component at this time whereas AMCOS can cost the drilling Reserve Component and we use the Active costs as a start for the AGRs. AMCOS estimates military training down to the MOS level which the Army needs for weapon system costing. FCoM divides the military

training by population. All Soldiers get the same amount. Some occupations require more training than others like pilots. AMCOS weights the costs by inventory of the prior year. FCoM doesn't weight based on inventory it asks for YOS which a lot of users don't really know. AMCOS and FCoM are both great models that serve the Army and DoD well. FCoM can cost the other services for studies of joint issues and joint weapon system initiatives.

PAY PLAN

DO YOU HAVE DIRECT LABOR RATES FOR GOVERNMENT CONTRACTORS?

You can find direct labor rates in AMCOS using the Contractor Cost Estimate pay plan inside AMCOS Lite.

DOES THE FM&C WEBSITE PROVIDE CME DATA?

AMCOS has the ability to estimate "costs" for contractors, sometimes called CMEs (Contractor Manhour Equivalents). AMCOS would not provide hours for contractor services. DASA-CE recommends using an actual contract for contractor costs when available, when starting a new effort where an existing or similar contract would not exist, AMCOS may be used. The contractor costs in AMCOS are under Contractor Cost Estimate in AMCOS Lite and Project Manager. There is also Pay Plan Xwalk if you need to crosswalk from civilian and military occupations to contractor occupations or vice versa.

DOES AMCOS PROVIDE OVERSEAS COSTS?

AMCOS now provides some overseas costs for select civilian and military personnel. For civilians it uses the Department of State overseas allowance data while Military uses the Defense Travel Management Office (DTMO) overseas Military Housing Area costs. GFEBs based pay plans display overseas costs for only those locations where the Army has existing personnel. AMCOS does not provide overseas cost for contractors.

WHAT IS LAB DEMO COSTING?

Laboratory Demo Pay Plans are broken out by Science and Technology Reinvention Laboratories (STRL) in AMCOS using the following procedures.

- AMCOS ingests data from GFEBs for all the D series pay plans. In that data we get the UIC for each person.
- We cross walk that UIC back to the parent organization's STRL
- Each STRL has its own definition of the pay banding to GS cross walk, for example here is ARI's — <https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2019/11/22/2019-25201/departments-of-defense-science-and-technology-reinvention-laboratory-strl-personnel-demonstration>

- AMCOS then generates the average cost of pay based on the formula $\text{sum (salary * number receiving)} / \text{sum (total inventory)}$

- The above is then checked against the STRL's pay banding limits and those outside of pay band are adjusted to be inside the pay band, or thrown out if they are too far outside of the pay bands. These outliers may occur due to reporting issues with the UIC field in GFEBS such as a transferred employee with their old pay but a new UIC or vice versa.

- A similar process to the above is followed for the other cost elements although the AMCOS cost model document is a better source for the detailed methodology for those elements

You can't get a D series average cost for the entire pay plan without selecting an STRL. This was done purposely because say DE ARI and DE CCDC STRL have different approved definitions of pay banding and thus are an apples to oranges comparison.

PROGRAM UPDATES

HOW CAN I LOCATE THE AMCOS WEBSITE?

Access to AMCOS is located on the website: <https://www.cave.army.mil>. AMCOS is set up to go through EAMS-A which requires a CAC/PKI to login. For contractors, if your contract requires you to access AMCOS, your government contract owner can sponsor you for a CAC.

HOW CAN I REPORT ERRORS?

AMCOS gets better when the users of the system bring forth possible errors and we can make corrections. Please provide details or screen captures of any issue(s) and put in a ticket with the Helpdesk at <https://helpdesk.cave.army.mil>

IS THERE AN ARMY CES CROSSWALK?

The prior version of AMCOS is not available any longer however, for the new Army CES we've posted a crosswalk to the old one. You may access it in AMCOS through the Help Docs link on the far right side of the menu then scroll down to the last entry titled 'Army Current-Former CES Xwalk'. That will get you back to the prior Army CES so you can see where the prior CES fit into the new Army CES structure.

WHAT ARE THE RELEASE DATES FOR NEW AMCOS DATA?

The AMCOS release occurs every year in April or May depending on data availability and Government Acceptance Testing (GAT) timelines. Minor updates to the site to make corrections and/or add new functionality may occur at any time.

WHAT'S INCLUDED IN THE MOST RECENT AMCOS RELEASE

Please refer to the release history document for the latest updates.

WHAT IS THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN AMCOS LITE AND PROJECT MANAGER?

AMCOS Lite provides a simple way to look up and retrieve cost factors for one type of manpower for the current FY, but with the capability to convert the current dollars to constant or current dollars in different target years. AMCOS Lite also provides manpower training costs per weapon system. The AMCOS Project Manager is similar in many ways to AMCOS Lite, but it very importantly provides the ability to cost whole organizations of thousands of employees across all the types of manpower: military, civilian and contractor at one time. Additionally, Project Manager can perform multi-year cost analyses. Last, AMCOS Project Manager also provides the analyst the ability to discount their manpower cost estimate.

SPECIAL PAY

DOES AMCOS LITE INCLUDE HAZARD PAY AND OTHER COSTS NEEDED FOR A MILITARY PERSON THAT IS DEPLOYED?

AMCOS contains average costs for Hazardous Duty Pay. That can be found by selecting the "detailed" selection from Summary drop down. However, if you are looking to cost at the individual level the actual amounts varies by the role the service member is filling. The DFAS cost table for the various scenarios is located here — <http://militarypay.defense.gov/Pay/Special-and-Incentive-Pays/HDIP/>.

WHAT IS THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN A BONUS VERSUS A SPECIAL PAY?

Special pays are a discretionary monetary incentive paid to Soldiers who qualify for and serve in designated special duty assignments. Special duty assignment pay is in addition to any other pay and allowances to which Soldiers are entitled. The only personnel cost element that would be impacted by special pays is the Government's share of FICA on taxable special pay amounts.